The 10 margin leaks of a hotel bar

Cheers Experiences checklist · Walk the bar in 20 minutes and tick what you find.

01 One pour too many. Margin too thin.

☐ Happens in my bar

Free pouring makes the cost of every drink unpredictable. The excess repeats, glass after glass.

How to fix it: Standardise measures and use a jigger.

02 High sales. Little left over.

☐ Happens in my bar

Without drink specifications, you may sell cocktails without knowing what each one really costs.

How to fix it: Calculate the full cost of every recipe.

03 Your neighbour's prices do not pay your bills.

☐ Happens in my bar

Copying prices ignores your costs, your service and the margin you need.

How to fix it: Set prices based on cost and the value you deliver.

04 Waste ends up on the bill too.

☐ Happens in my bar

Over-cut fruit, forgotten juices and excess prep add up to losses.

How to fix it: Prep to forecast demand and record waste.

05 Without stock counts, losses hide.

☐ Happens in my bar

Without matching stock to sales, over-pours, comps and breakages go unnoticed.

How to fix it: Count stock and compare actual usage with expected usage.

06 Idle bottles. Trapped cash.

☐ Happens in my bar

Buying products that barely sell ties up cash and takes up space.

How to fix it: Set purchasing and quantities by each product's rotation.

07 Does your menu know how to sell?

☐ Happens in my bar

Hiding high-margin, high-demand drinks wastes the potential of every order.

How to fix it: Highlight profitable choices with clear descriptions.

08 The team serves. But can it recommend?

☐ Happens in my bar

Simply taking orders leaves choices unexplored that guests would value.

How to fix it: Train relevant suggestions, with clear prices and no pressure.

09 Every minute of waiting can cost a sale.

☐ Happens in my bar

Poor prep and a disorganised station slow service at peak times.

How to fix it: Set up the station before opening and simplify movements.

10 The wrong shift costs money.

☐ Happens in my bar

Too many staff in quiet hours and too few at peaks raise costs and lose sales.

How to fix it: Match shifts to demand and to the tasks of each period.

Found two or more?

The Mystery Guest Bar Audit puts a euro figure on them and tells you what to fix first. From €990 + travel depending on the country (plus VAT in Portugal). If we do not identify at least €990 a month in lost sales or waste, we refund the audit fee.

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